REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

Stronger Nonprofits Capacity Grants: 2027 Request for Proposals

Competitive capacity-building grant (two-stage) · Letters of inquiry due November 13, 2026

At a glance

Funding: $5,000 to $20,000

Type of support: Capacity-building project support

Term: Twelve months, beginning March 1, 2027

Total available: Approximately $180,000

Geographic eligibility: Organizations must be headquartered in Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties.

Program page: https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/grants/stronger-nonprofits-capacity-grants/

About the program

Strong communities need strong nonprofits. Stronger Nonprofits Capacity Grants fund time-limited projects that make an organization more effective and resilient, such as a strategic plan, a new financial management system, a fundraising plan, board development, or leadership succession planning.

Capacity grants are paired with the Foundation's Nonprofit Learning Hub. Grantees join a peer cohort that meets four times during the grant year, and many projects use consultants from the Foundation's vetted consultant roster.

Capacity grants do not count against an organization's eligibility for Community Impact Grants.

Focus and impact areas

Focus areas: Civic & Economic Opportunity.

We welcome proposals that address one or more of the following impact areas:

- Strategic and business planning
- Financial management systems and controls
- Fund development planning and donor database systems
- Board recruitment, training, and governance policies
- Technology, data, and cybersecurity improvements
- Executive transition and leadership succession planning

Populations served

- Nonprofit staff, executive directors, and board members
- Communities served by small and mid-sized nonprofits

Eligibility

Geographic eligibility

Organizations must be headquartered in Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties.

Who may apply

- Tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3), or a tribal nonprofit program
- Headquartered in Coconino, Yavapai, Navajo, or Apache counties
- Annual operating budget between $50,000 and $2 million
- At least one paid staff member or a full-time volunteer executive
- Executive director and board chair commit to participating in the peer learning cohort

What we do not fund

- Ongoing program or operating costs
- Fiscally sponsored projects
- Capital equipment unrelated to the capacity project
- Organizations that received a Stronger Nonprofits Capacity Grant in 2025 or 2026

Funding

$5,000 to $20,000. Capacity-building project support.

Key dates

Milestone	Date
Application period opens	Thursday, October 1, 2026
Letter of inquiry deadline	Friday, November 13, 2026, 6:00 p.m. MST
Invitations to submit a full application	Sent by December 4, 2026
Full application deadline	Friday, January 22, 2027, 6:00 p.m. MST
Decision	Award decisions announced by February 19, 2027
Grant period	March 1, 2027 – February 29, 2028

How to apply

Capacity grants use a two-stage process. Completing the Capacity Readiness Self-Assessment before submitting a letter of inquiry is required.

1. **Assess readiness.** Complete the Capacity Readiness Self-Assessment with your board chair. Attach it to your letter of inquiry.
2. **Submit a letter of inquiry.** Complete the Letter of Inquiry Template and email it with the self-assessment to learning@cinderpeakscf.org by 6:00 p.m. MST on November 13, 2026.
3. **Planning conversation.** Invited applicants meet with the Nonprofit Learning Coordinator to refine the project scope. Invitations are sent by December 4, 2026.
4. **Submit the full application.** Submit the full application, Grant Project Budget Template, and any consultant proposal in the CPCF Grant Portal by 6:00 p.m. MST on January 22, 2027.
5. **Decision and cohort launch.** Awards are announced by February 19, 2027. The first cohort session takes place in March 2027.

Review criteria

- The project addresses a clearly identified organizational need
- Leadership and board commitment
- Realistic scope, timeline, and budget
- Potential to strengthen the organization's long-term sustainability

Reporting requirements

Grantees submit a mid-year progress report and a final grant report, and participate in all four cohort sessions.

- Progress on project milestones
- Changes in organizational practice resulting from the project
- Budget-to-actual expenses and consultant deliverables

Due: Interim report due September 15, 2027; final report due March 31, 2028.

Templates and supporting documents

- **Letter of Inquiry Template:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-letter-of-inquiry-template.pdf
- **Capacity Readiness Self-Assessment:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-capacity-readiness-self-assessment.pdf
- **Grant Project Budget Template:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-grant-project-budget-template.pdf
- **Interim Progress Report Form:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/reporting/cpcf-interim-progress-report-form.pdf
- **Final Grant Report Form:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/reporting/cpcf-final-grant-report-form.pdf

Questions?

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